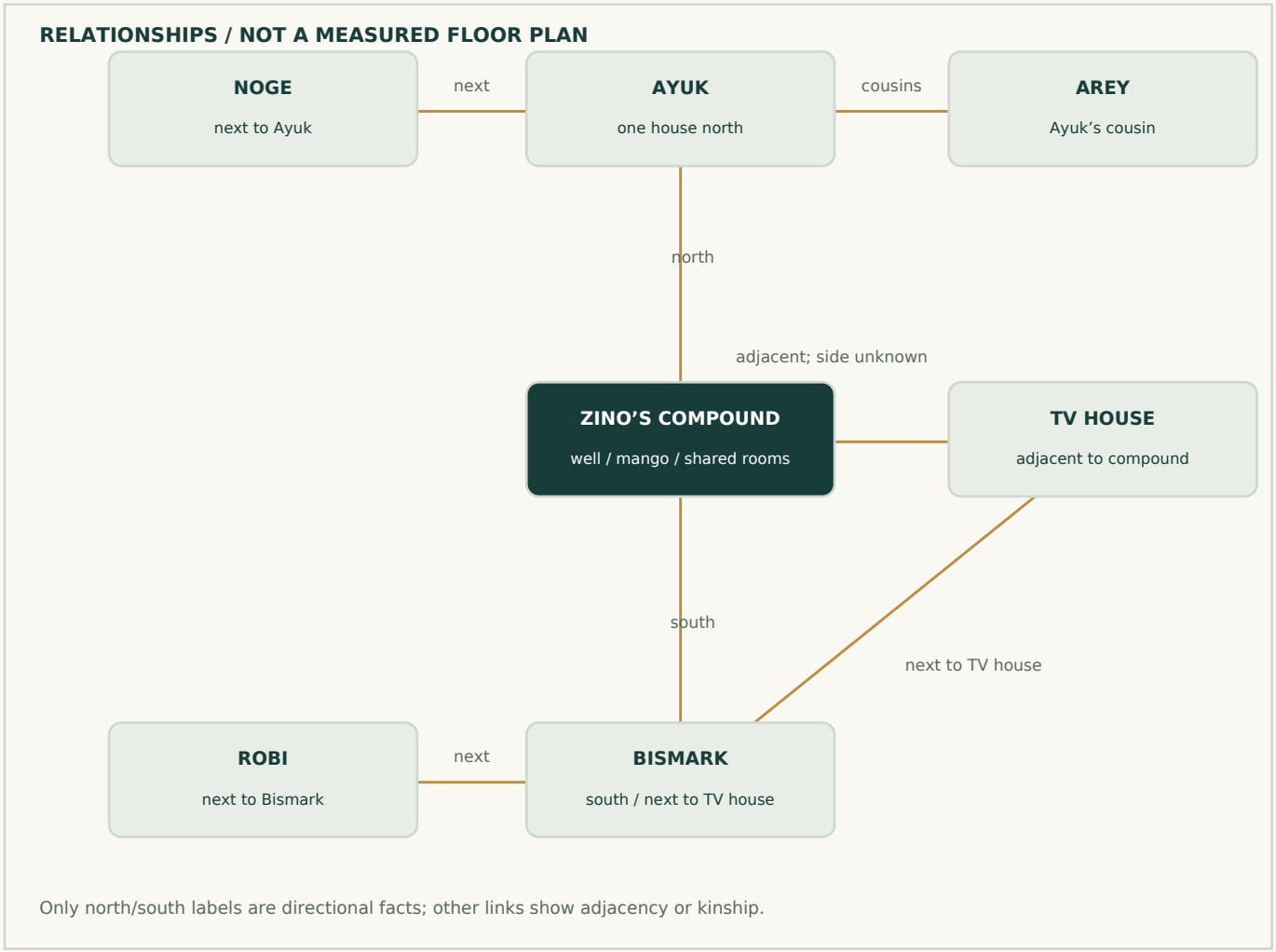
Fiango: who lives where

An adjacency guide from Zino’s recollections. This diagram does not invent compass directions, addresses, room measurements or a home for Arey.



Room correction: Zino’s room is two apartments away from Mother’s front room. The tenants share two bathrooms. A separate detailed compound plan needs the doorway/room arrangement and ages confirmed.

Football correction: Ayuk, Arey, Noge, Bismark and Robi play with Zino. Gideon watches and banters. Luc evangelises or chats. None of these names has been identified as a later crypto associate.

The pickup, motel and poultry trade

The road and hotel belong to the weekday geography. This great-aunt is Mother’s aunt, not the maternal aunt later killed.

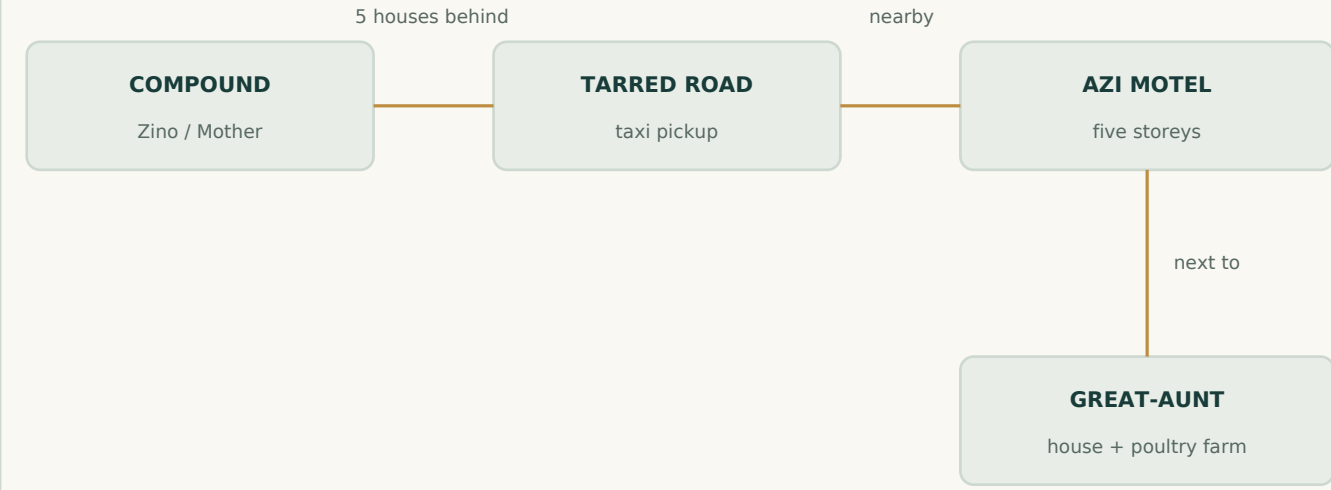


Diagram placement does not assign a compass bearing to “behind” or “nearby”.

School budget: 200 CFA = 100 taxi + 100 at school. A single morning ride costs 100; taxis are taken on three mornings a week. Walking early preserves the full 200 for school spending.

Uniform: light sky-blue short-sleeved shirts for both boys and girls; dark-blue trousers for boys, dark-blue skirts for girls. Boarding uniform remains unconfirmed.

Working ages: Form One about 10–11, Two 11–12, Three 12–13, Four 13–14, Five 14–15. These author-authorized estimates do not establish exact birthdays.

GRAND-CHUKUCHUKU

Fiango — daily life, neighbourhood and character update

Source: Zino's recollections supplied on 30 October 2026.

Authority: This update supersedes conflicting proposed details in the earlier character bible, scripts and concept art.

Key: C = author-supplied recollection; P = proposed dramatic or visual treatment; OPEN = not yet settled. No suggested scene is a claimed transcript.

1. A weekday has its own ticking clock

5:30 a.m. — the cocks behind his room

C: Zino wakes to cock-crowing behind his room around 5:30. Four buckets come before school: two rounds to the well, one full bucket in each hand on each return.

P — screen treatment: Begin with sound in darkness, then a low shot of two bucket handles pulling down on his hands. The first round is not the last. A wide shot establishes the actual route from his detached room to the shared well. This can show fatigue, humour and household duty before anyone explains poverty.

The bathroom queue

C: Tenants share two bathrooms. Zino waits his turn. Feet and lower shins are visible under the short door, telling someone outside that it is occupied.

P — screen treatment: Show only closed doors and feet from the ordinary queue's viewpoint. An impatient toe tapping outside answers still feet inside. No camera enters an occupied cubicle; there is no nudity. Whether this exact door detail applies to bathrooms, toilets or both remains open.

Two rooms, not one

C: Zino has his own room, two apartments detached from his mother's room toward the front. Her room contains a queen-size bed and a drawer beside it. After getting ready for school, he enters her room to check the money left in that drawer.

C — later addition: Mother trusts him. The separation between their rooms means he can come and go or sleep late without her always knowing. This is freedom within their particular living arrangement; it does not establish neglect, permission for every activity, or her constant absence.

P — screen treatment: The route between rooms creates private and public space: he must pass other tenants before reaching Mother. Do not invent a locked door, secret drawer, missing cash or theft. Checking the money is his routine, not automatically a suspicious act. Exact room dimensions and the age at which this arrangement began are open.

The 200-CFA decision

C: Usually two coins totalling 200 CFA are left for school. He can use 100 for transport and spend 100 at school. If he gets ready early enough to walk, he can keep the 200 for school. Earlier recollections establish that he sometimes saves lunch money for Nacking Bottle.

Clarified: a single taxi ride costs 100 CFA from the pickup to school, on three mornings per week. It is not three connecting rides. Two coins totalling 200 are confirmed; exact denominations need not be drawn. Exact weekdays and travel time remain open.

P — dramatic engine: Time, effort, hunger and football all draw on the same small budget. A late bathroom queue can change his transport decision. An early start can buy a better school day. That is a real choice; it does not need an invented criminal threat.

2. The TV window and the neighbourhood

C: Beside the compound, a household has a large TV. Zino and other children stand outside a steel-barred window to watch. Later Ayuk's father buys a TV, and Zino watches sport and films inside Ayuk's home, one house from the compound, sometimes until 9 p.m.

Clarified: 'college' means the five secondary day-school years. Ayuk's TV belongs in that period; the exact form/year is still open. Programme titles, TV model, power reliability and the owner's treatment of the children remain unconfirmed.

Relative locations supplied

• **Ayuk:** a house north of Zino's compound; later also described as one house away.

• **Arey:** Ayuk's cousin. A separate house or sleeping arrangement has not been supplied.

• **Noge:** lives next to Ayuk's house; east or west is unspecified.

• **Bismark:** south, next to the TV house.

• **Robi:** next to Bismark; a compass side is unspecified.

• **Original TV house:** adjacent to the compound; do not infer a precise compass side from the other relationships.

• **Taxi pickup / major road:** a tarred road five houses behind the compound. 'Behind' is not yet a compass bearing. Travel time is unconfirmed.

• **Azi Motel:** a nearby five-storey motel. Do not turn the building name into a verified street address.

• **Mother's aunt's home and poultry farm:** next to Azi Motel, supplying poultry directly to it and other hotels. This is Zino's great-aunt, distinct from the maternal aunt later killed. 'Poetry/peotry' is interpreted as poultry from context.

The companion diagram is an adjacency schematic, not a surveyed map. The supplied compound image remains a material/visual reference; it cannot overrule the author's new room, bathroom or neighbour details.

3. The football circle — corrected

C: Zino's street-playing circle includes Ayuk, Arey, Noge, Bismark and Robi. The author describes them as the same age group and class. Luc and Gideon do not play.

Zino

Plays. His ambition, skill, pride and temper can all surface in one ordinary street match. Do not infer that he is always the best player or always wins.

Ayuk

C: A neighbour north of the compound, a class/age peer and a football participant; his father's later TV makes his home part of the group's evening world. **P — design proposal:** an easily read straight-backed silhouette and a cobalt accent distinguish him from Gideon's olive. Hair, body shape, exact clothing and personality await references.

Arey

C: Ayuk's cousin and a football participant in the same circle. **P — design proposal:** a distinct side-part silhouette or rust-coloured sleeve stripe can separate the cousins. Do not make him Ayuk's visual double or invent a rivalry.

Noge

C: Neighbour next to Ayuk, class/age peer, football participant. **P — design proposal:** an open, square stance and one pale-yellow clothing accent. No position, temperament or football skill is yet confirmed.

Bismark

C: Lives south, next to the TV house; a player and peer. **P — design proposal:** a longer shirt silhouette and one maroon accent. His home position does not establish that he owns the TV or polices access.

Robi

C: Lives next to Bismark, a player and peer. **P — design proposal:** a compact, forward-leaning pose and a muted turquoise accent. These are staging ideas, not a real physical description.

Gideon — the sideline voice

C: Does not play. He sits watching and bantering with Zino, particularly when Zino loses. His camera work, business interests, quietness with girls and friendship with Zino remain intact. He constantly finds gigs, sells things or exchanges services for money. By Form Five he has a place in the market selling bread. He also turns to Zino to explain schoolwork. Zino calls him **Giddy**; the canonical name is **Gideon**, including when the author's message says Gideo.

C — visual correction: W-shaped hairline and fuller, almost-afro hair replace the earlier generic short-cropped proposal. Exact hair length at individual ages remains open. **Correction:** earlier goalkeeper, scoring teammate and demanding-a-pass scenes are superseded. His humour can puncture Zino's public performance without making their friendship cruel.

Luc — a different use for the same evening

C: Does not play. He spends time evangelising or chatting. His small Bible and Zino's maths help remain part of their friendship. He lifts weights in the evenings, using homemade mud-formed dumbbells, and has a sand-filled punching bag. He has a muscular, bodybuilder-like build and a high flat-top haircut. Zino calls him **Lucky Luc** when he encounters him by himself.

C / OPEN — visual correction: The earlier lean/slender design is superseded. His training's starting age and changes in physique across the school years are not supplied. Keep child proportions at ten; do not back-project an adult bodybuilder's anatomy onto the opening. **Correction:** do not automatically make him a referee, scorer or touchline commentator in every match; he may be having an entirely separate conversation nearby. Exercise, conversation and preaching need not all occur on the same evening.

4. School relationships — keep their timelines distinct

Lizzy

C: Zino's crush in Form One, girlfriend from Form Two, breakup in Form Three. The author corrected his earlier Form Four statement. He recalls her going with an older student who had money.

OPEN: Elianne, previously named first love, is not automatically Lizzy, an alias, or a character to delete. Lizzy's school timeline is now resolved; Elianne's separate place still needs explanation.

P — character treatment: School-age affection, conversation, jealousy and hurt can carry the relationship. Give Lizzy her own perspective. Zino's account of money and the older student is his recollection, not a licence to invent every motive or turn her into a villain.

Mirabel

C: Friendship begins in Form Three because of Zino's brilliance in maths and continues until he leaves for America. **P — character treatment:** a friendship that can outlast classrooms and physical distance. Proposed visual marker: a geometric notebook cover, careful underlining and a distinct hair silhouette once references arrive. Do not infer romance, jealousy or a love triangle.

Sophy

C: Gideon is in love with her from Form Two to Form Five. Zino recalls her as attractive and interested in money; she makes repeated advances toward him, and he turns her down out of loyalty to Gideon.

P — character treatment: Express interest through conversation, chosen company and expectations about spending. Keep her school-age design and camera framing nonsexual. Do not caricature her body or treat her as inherently dishonest. Proposed design marker: a neat, deliberately coordinated school bag or hair accessory, not sexualised clothing.

Tracey

C / OPEN: An older student who attends the night-study space. Zino reports his first sexual experience with her while in Form Three, described as after the Lizzy breakup. Both ages, the precise ordering and the circumstances still need his account.

C — later addition: She has already sat the GCE twice without passing. She sees Zino teaching maths to students who subsequently pass the GCE. This gives her an academic connection to the study space; it does not establish her exact age, private motives, a transaction, or that Zino alone caused anyone's examination result.

Treatment: Preserve the disclosure in neutral biographical notes. Do not script or illustrate an explicit sexual scene involving school-age Zino. If later included, use a non-graphic transition and his own description of its emotional meaning. Do not invent adult status, consent, coercion, culpability or a relationship label. No seductive character art is requested or needed for this update.

School uniform and working ages

C: All students wear light sky-blue short-sleeved shirts. Boys wear dark-blue trousers; girls wear dark-blue skirts. Earlier white/cream/brown school palettes are superseded. Distinguish characters through faces, hairstyles, posture, bags and books rather than changing the uniform colour.

P — ages authorized as estimates: Form One about 10–11, Form Two 11–12, Form Three 12–13, Form Four 13–14, Form Five 14–15, using the approximate 2000–2005 day-school chronology and 1990 birth year. Exact birthdays and enrolment dates are not supplied. The author describes similar-age peers; Tracey being older does not establish that she was an adult.

5. Uncle — the suit, faith and cocoa

C: A renowned lawyer known for wearing suits. After giving his life to Christ, he becomes a cocoa businessman. By Zino's Form Three year he opens a large cocoa store in Kumba, with trailers carrying cocoa to Douala. He loved his late brother, Zino's father, deeply. That brother had limited formal education and grew and sold cocoa.

C — reported advice: Uncle tells Zino to study hard so he does not end up like his father. This is the uncle's reported framing, not a narrator's judgement of farming or of the father. His grief, class assumptions and hopes for Zino can coexist.

P — visual correction: The old casual-shirt concept does not establish his lawyer-era wardrobe. Use structured suits for that period. A later store/dispatch look must follow the actual timing and references; do not assume conversion meant poverty, an end to suits, or an instant change in personality.

Story opportunity: Cocoa links the brothers without making their lives identical: one grew it, another traded it at scale. Uncle urging Zino to leave the father's path while building his own future in the same commodity is a complex family tension, not automatically hypocrisy.

OPEN: Did legal work stop or overlap with trading? When did he convert? Why was support intermittent despite his status? What did his America promise mean financially? Do not invent business collapse, withholding, family cruelty or the reason for late fees.

6. How to use this in a thriller series

The extraordinary events need an ordinary world worth losing. Suspense can grow from a specific choice and a visible consequence; every bucket, TV programme and friendship does not need a sinister score.

Proposed three-act short seeds

1. **Four Buckets:** I — the cocks wake him and he wants an early start. II — two full rounds take work. III — the bathroom queue makes him calculate whether walking is still possible. Do not add a real accident without a memory.

2. **The Feet Under the Door:** I — Zino joins the queue. II — neighbours arrive with different schedules. III — his turn changes the morning's time budget. Keep framing outside occupied bathrooms.

3. **Two Coins:** I — the drawer contains 200 CFA. II — transport means spending half; walking costs time. III — choose one and carry that consequence into school.

4. **The Long Walk:** I — he leaves early enough. II — he passes ordinary neighbourhood activity. III — he reaches school with the money intact. Walking is a practical trade, not a magical cure for school fees.

5. **Gideon's Seat:** I — Zino needs a good game. II — Gideon narrates his mistakes from the sideline. III — Zino loses and must decide how to take a joke without turning on a friend.

6. **Two Evenings:** I — football attracts Zino. II — Luc finds someone willing to talk. III — their routes reconnect without either friend needing to imitate the other.

7. **Through the Bars:** I — children gather at the TV window. II — the view is narrow and a match or film matters. III — access becomes part of the pleasure and frustration. No invented ban or malicious owner is required.

8. **Ayuk's TV:** I — during secondary school, the group has a new place to watch. II — the evening grows late. III — 9 p.m. means home and tomorrow's 5:30 start. Exact form/year of purchase remains open.

9. **Mirabel's Sum:** I — a maths question starts a friendship in Form Three. II — mutual respect grows through repeated work. III — give her a response and an independent want; friendship need not become romance.

10. **Bro Code:** I — Gideon hopes Sophy will choose him. II — she approaches Zino instead. III — he refuses without publicly humiliating her or congratulating himself.

11. **The Store:** I — Zino sees his uncle's cocoa operation. II — the uncle urges education while work continues. III — Zino hears the reference to his father and carries a difficult question home. This is proposed staging; no warehouse visit is confirmed.

12. **Form Three:** I — Lizzy's connection with Zino matters. II — attention and money complicate it. III — the breakup happens in Form Three; record the exact sequence before adding Tracey's experience as an aftermath.

7. Corrections to carry into every active draft

• Luc and Gideon watch/socialise beside football; named street peers play. No invented trio team.

• Morning water is four buckets in two trips, one per hand; the new routine is not four separate trips.

• Separate bedrooms are two apartments apart; the illustration is not authority for a shared-bedroom scene.

• 200 CFA is the school allocation, not a fee amount or proof Mother left cash unattended for anyone to take.

• Taxi wording and the TV-era word are resolved by the author: three mornings a week, 100 CFA per ride; TV transition during secondary school. Do not invent the weekday pattern or exact purchase year.

• The new girls remain separate characters. Preserve Elianne until her identity/place is clarified.

• Father's cocoa work is a life and livelihood, not a failure verdict. Uncle's work and faith are now supplied facts, not generic mystery.

• The named childhood players have not been identified as the later crypto circle.

• Luc's muscular build and high flat-top supersede the lean design; Gideon's W-shaped hairline and almost-afro hair supersede the generic cropped-hair proposal. Keep age-appropriate versions rather than copying an older-school design unchanged onto ten-year-olds.

• Zino's own songwriting begins in Form Five, and his first demo follows his return home from boarding high school. Later writing in America continues that history; a draft implying that his music begins in America must change.

• The author's general GCE minimum pass thresholds, the maximum subjects available, Zino's own subjects and the school's pass rate are four different facts; none replaces another.

8. Questions awaiting Zino's corrections

1. Elianne's identity/place remains open. Lizzy's breakup is now fixed in Form Three.

2. Taxi frequency/fare is resolved. Exact weekdays and journey length remain open.

3. The TV era is secondary school. What form/year did Ayuk's father get the TV?

4. How old were Zino and Tracey? Record the experience in his own terms before assigning a label or dramatizing an aftermath.

5. From which age/form did Zino have the separate room, and are the feet-visible doors bathroom doors, toilet doors or both?

6. What is the sequence of the uncle's conversion, legal work and cocoa-store operation, and why were school payments sometimes late?

9. Latest character and education additions — 30 October 2026

Zino — understanding, music and faith

C: He quickly understands scientific concepts, with maths his favourite subject. He describes maths as easy, like a puzzle: he can work out an answer instead of doing the kind of reading he associates with History, Geography and Literature. This describes his preference and confidence, not illiteracy, lack of effort or an inability to learn other subjects.

C: He loves singing and starts writing his own songs in Form Five. He records his first demo after coming home from the two-year boarding high-school period. His later songwriting in America is a continuation.

P / OPEN — placement: On the existing working chronology, Form Five is around 2004–2005 and the first demo is after his high-school return around 2007. These are approximate placements, not newly confirmed recording dates. Demo title, collaborators, studio, cost and exact timing remain open. Do not place a completed demo in the earlier Fiango day-school years.

C: Zino is Catholic and serves at Mass throughout primary school. Secondary-school demands leave him without time to continue altar service. Reduced service is not evidence that he abandons his faith or becomes Luc's religious opposite.

P — character use: Let confidence in a maths problem sit beside a song idea he is still struggling to express. Faith can appear through an ordinary practice or memory when its timing is supported. Invented lyrics, lessons and dialogue remain dramatic proposals, not recovered testimony.

GCE — keep four measures separate

C — author's account of the examination system: A paper means a subject in this account. The minimum pass threshold is four subjects at Ordinary Level and two at Advanced Level. These are the author's supplied rules for the story; historical regulations have not been independently verified here.

Measure	Ordinary Level	Advanced Level
General minimum pass threshold supplied by the author	4 subjects	2 subjects
Maximum subjects supplied by the author	11 subjects	5 subjects
Zino's reported subjects	10 subjects	5 subjects
His boarding school's reported pass rate	Not supplied	100%

The uncle's promise specifically depends on Zino succeeding in all five Advanced-Level subjects, a higher condition than the author's general two-subject minimum. The school's 100% pass rate does not mean every student takes or passes five subjects, and it supplies no Ordinary-Level school statistic.

Friendship, work and trust on screen

C: Luc's weights and punching bag belong to his evening life. Gideon's market bread place belongs by Form Five; earlier camera work, small trades and paid services precede or coexist with it as the author describes. His quietness with girls does not make him passive about business. Zino's maths help extends to Gideon as well as Luc and other students.

Three-act short seeds — proposed

1. **Lucky Luc:** I — Zino finds Luc training alone. II — a conversation competes with the next set of homemade weights. III — the nickname lands in a private friendship moment. Place at an age consistent with the eventual training chronology; do not invent a dangerous stunt or athletic victory.

2. **Giddy's Bread:** I — in Form Five, Gideon must give attention to a customer at his market place. II — he brings Zino a schoolwork problem between tasks. III — business confidence and academic uncertainty share the same character. Exact prices, takings, ownership terms and Zino's presence there are proposed or open.

3. **The First Song:** I — Form Five Zino begins a lyric. II — a melody resists the easy certainty he finds in maths. III — he keeps working. Save the first recorded demo for after boarding high school; do not invent an instant music career.

OPEN: When did Luc begin training, and how did his build and haircut change? What did Gideon's market arrangement involve? Which school year did each nickname start? What was the first song and where was the demo recorded? These gaps do not block the confirmed traits, but they limit precise scene dates and props.